

Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

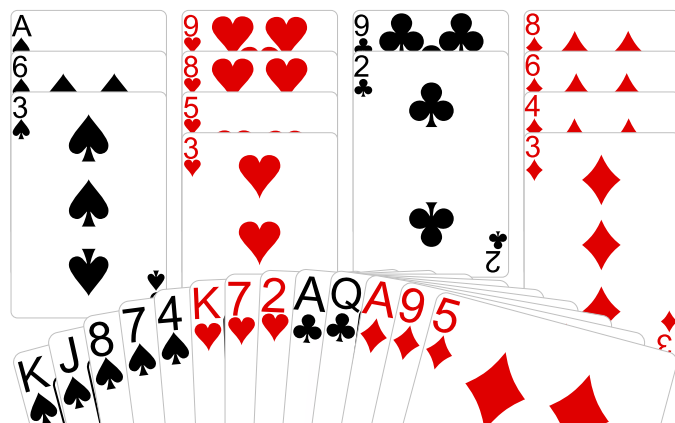
respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

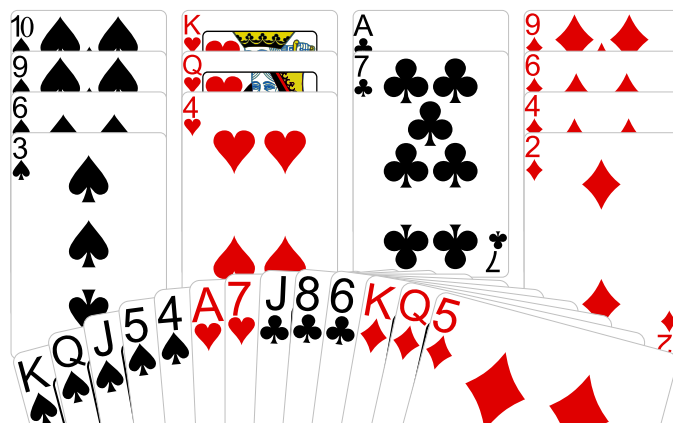
respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Deal 1 Ctr: 1♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



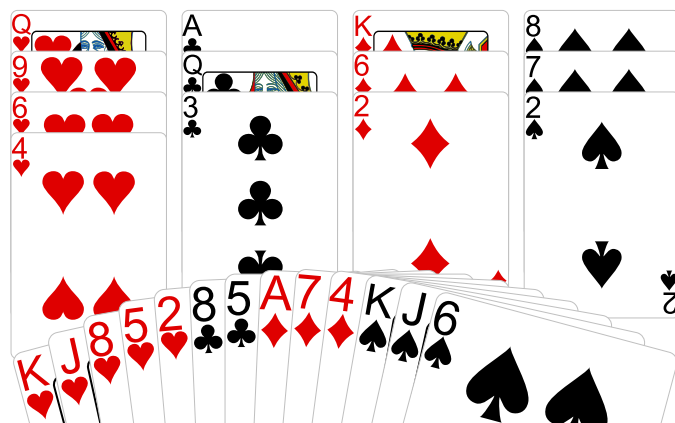
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



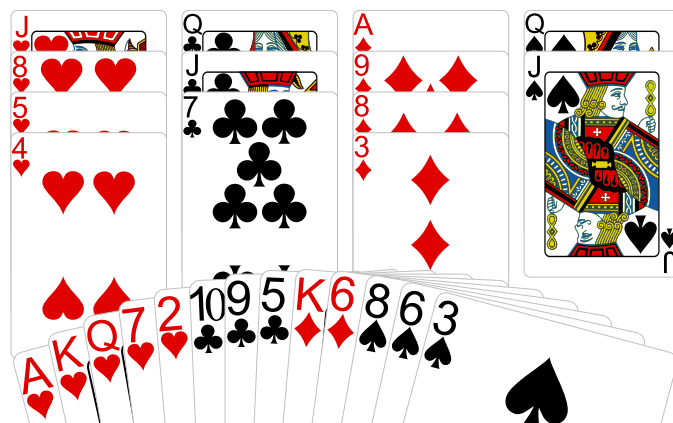
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 3♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 3♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 1♠
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3♥
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3♥
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 2♠
Declarer: North

Deal 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 9
♥ Q J T 6
♦ J 2
♣ K J 8 7 6 3

17
8 11
4

♠ K J 8 7 4
♥ K 7 2
♦ A 9 5
♣ A Q



♠ A 6 3
♥ 9 8 5 3
♦ 8 6 4 3
♣ 9 2

♠ Q T 5 2
♥ A 4
♦ K Q T 7
♣ T 5 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	1 ♠		Pass
All Pass			
1 ♠ by North			

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SOUTH has a terrible hand, and naturally passes.

NORTH, however, has a nice 18 points and opens 1 ♠.

SOUTH still has a terrible hand, and passes again. You need at least 6 points to respond to

an opening one bid.

Deal 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ T 9 6 3
♥ K Q 4
♦ 9 6 4 2
♣ A 7

7
9 16
8

West

2 ♠

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

♠ 7
♥ 9 6 5 3 2
♦ A 7 3
♣ K 9 5 2

N
W E
S

♠ A 8 2
♥ J T 8
♦ J T 8
♣ Q T 4 3

North

Pass

East

1 ♠

3 ♠

South

Pass

Pass

♠ K Q J 5 4
♥ A 7
♦ K Q 5
♣ J 8 6

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EAST has 17 points and might open 1NT. But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers

to open 1 ♠.

WEST has good ♠ support and 10 points, counting 1 for the doubleton ♣.

It is easily worth a raise to 2 ♠

EAST cannot bid game yet, after all, WEST could have as few as 6 points. But she can

continue with a 3 ♠ bid in hopes that WEST actually has 9 or 10 points.

WEST comes through with 4 ♠.

Deal 3

South Deals
None Vul

♠ T 9 4 3
♥ A T 7
♦ Q 5 3
♣ K 7 2

11
9 8
12

♠ 8 7 2
♥ Q 9 6 4
♦ K 6 2
♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 6
♥ K J 8 5 2
♦ A 7 4
♣ 8 5

♠ A Q 5
♥ 3
♦ J T 9 8
♣ J T 9 6 4

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SOUTH has a bare minimum 13 point hand,
and he should open 1

♥

.

NORTH has 11 points and good

♥

support so she jumps to 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	3♥		1♥
All Pass			

♥

.

3♥ by South

SOUTH knows he has been invited to bid higher, but with nothing above minimum he must pass.

Deal 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 6 3
♥ A K Q 7 2
♦ K 6
♣ T 9 5

7
12 11
10

♠ T 7 5 4 2

♥ T 9 6

♦ 5 2

♣ A K 4



♠ A K 9

♥ 3

♦ Q J T 7 4

♣ 8 6 3 2

♠ Q J
♥ J 8 5 4
♦ A 9 8 3
♣ Q J 7

West

North

East

South

1♥

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by West
can add and he knows the total points will

be either 24 or 25. So he passes 3

♥

.

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EAST has 11 points and she should pass.

WEST has a minimum 1

♥

opening, 13 points and five trumps.

EAST, with 4-card trump support, jumps to 3

♥

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(This is called a Limit Raise.)

A Limit Raise is an invitational bid, but WEST

Deal 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 4
♥ T 9 8 6
♦ A K J T 6
♣ J 9 8

13
9 12
6

♠ K Q T 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A 6



♠ J 9 6 2

♥ K Q 7 5

♦ 8 3

♣ T 7 4

♠ A 8 5

♥ J 3

♦ Q 4 2

♣ K Q 5 3 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

All Pass

2 ♠ by North

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NORTH has a normal 1 ♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

SOUTH has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to 2 ♠.

NORTH passes, knowing he is not missing a game contract. SOUTH can have a maximum of 10 points, which would

only reach 24 points when added to his 14.